AI may help speed hiring, but it could come at a cost

Experts and applicants worry about algorithm-driven picks, the possibility of bias. **In Money**

KJ Apa works to find his voice as Jimmy Stewart

The actor mastered the icon's familiar cadence for "Jimmy," but it's not an impression. **In Life**



ERIC CANHA/IMAGN IMAGES VIA REUTERS

Week 10 helps vindicate CFP choices

Big winners include Alabama, Tennessee and Notre Dame, with coach Marcus Freeman, left, which upset Miami. **In Sports**

USA TODAY

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Midterms reshape political landscape

These shifts could have lasting consequences



Susan Page
Washington Bureau Chief
USA TODAY

The nation's biggest political shift in a half-century sparked a flood of jaw-dropping headlines.

Democrats take control of the House and Senate, winning even in such deep red states as Kansas and South Carolina. Electoral breakthroughs for candidates who are Black, Hispanic, Native American or gay. A Democratic socialist elected mayor in the nation's second-largest city, Los Angeles, joining one elected in 2025 in the largest, New York.

With the final votes now being counted from the Nov. 3 midterm elections, here are five of the most jaw-dropping developments of all – and the ones with the biggest potential for lasting repercussions.



Texas Gov.-elect Gina Hinojosa will become the state's first Democratic governor since Ann Richards was elected in 1990.
JOEL ANGEL JUAREZ/REUTERS

Most seismic shift by a state: Texas

Texas Democrats, who had not won a statewide elected office since 1994, carried all of them.

Gina Hinojosa ousted Greg Abbott, the nation's longest-serving governor, and newcomer James Talarico defeated Ken Paxton, a fixture in Texas politics. Democratic candidates won races for lieutenant governor, attorney general, comptroller, land commissioner, agriculture commissioner and railroad commissioner, and they claimed seven statewide judicial elections, including four seats on the state's Supreme Court.

It was a Texas-sized sweep.

The swing was especially stunning among Latino voters, who make up nearly one-third of the state's eligible voters.

Hispanics who had swung to Donald Trump in 2024 snapped back to Democrats, especially in the Rio Grande Valley and other Texas border counties. That trend was nationwide: Per exit polls sponsored by NBC News and other news organizations, Democrats carried Latinos by 30 percentage points, 64%-34%.

If Democrats can succeed in making the Lone Star State blue or even purple, that could have seismic repercussions for the calculations on how to

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Kasey and Tim Jackson – with their children Elliot, Noah and Elijah – have been on ACA plans for years.
PHOTOS PROVIDED BY KASEY JACKSON

Families lose ACA hospital options

Scramble to find solution as kids face treatment needs

Madeline Mitchell USA TODAY

Kasey Jackson's 13-year-old son, Elijah, is battling cancer. Again. • All of her thoughts should be on her son and his health, but Jackson said she's preoccupied. In October, she found out from her insurance broker that Children's Mercy Hospital in Kansas City, Missouri, where her son receives care, will no longer accept any coverage plans associated with the Affordable Care Act, or ACA, starting in January.

"I am very angry right now," Jackson said in a recent TikTok that was viewed by more than 400,000 users. "There are no options available for people that do not qualify for an employee-sponsored plan to get care for their children, at the only children's hospital where they can get care."

Jackson and her husband were self-employed when Elijah was first diagnosed with acute lymphoblastic leukemia at 8 years old. He went

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> **"That's the only hospital we can go to for treatment. There's no other options."**
> **Kasey Jackson**



Elijah, 13, is battling cancer for the second time.

Winter weather unlikely in November



A mother and son wade in the water at Higgins Beach in Scarborough, Maine, on Nov. 2. Warm weather is expected nationwide during the month. KEVIN LAMARQUE/REUTERS

Experts: El Niño keeping temps higher than usual

Doyle Rice
USA TODAY

Widespread chilly weather still seems a long way away despite what the calendar says, as the nation is forecast to see one of the warmest Novembers on record, thanks mainly to the warming impacts of El Niño, forecasters said.

"The ongoing El Niño remains the dominant teleconnection to influence this forecast," said Johnna Infanti, a forecaster from the National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration's Climate Prediction Center, in an online report.

Chad Merrill, a senior meteorologist from AccuWeather, told USA TODAY that "a very warm month is expected nationally. It will likely rank in the top 10 for warmest Novembers."

The temperature forecast map from the Climate Prediction Center shows that above-average temperatures are likely practically coast-to-coast.

On the map, only the Southwest is not forecast to see above-normal temperatures.

In that region, there are "equal chances" of seeing warmer-than-average or cooler-than-average temperatures.

No part of the United States is forecast to see below-average temperatures in November.

Specifically, Merrill told USA TODAY that "Northern California into the Northwest into the northern portion of

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